

# CURRICULUM VITAE – MINDA ZHAO

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| CONTACT           | Minda Zhao Email : <a href="mailto:mindazhao@gatech.edu">mindazhao@gatech.edu</a><br>Website : <a href="https://minda-zhao.github.io/Personal-Website">https://minda-zhao.github.io/Personal-Website</a><br>Address : Room 422, ISyE Main Building, 755 Ferst Dr NW, Atlanta, GA 30332                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |  |  |
| EDUCATION         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● <b>Georgia Institute of Technology (Gatech)</b> Atlanta, GA<br/><i>Ph.D. student in Operations Research</i> 2022 - 2027 (Expected)<br/>– Advisor : Prof. Xin Chen</li><li>● <b>University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign (UIUC)</b> Champaign, IL<br/><i>Ph.D. student in Industrial Engineering</i> 2021 - 2022<br/>– Transferred to Georgia Institute of Technology.</li><li>● <b>University of Chicago (UChicago)</b> Chicago, IL<br/><i>M.S. in Computational and Applied Mathematics</i> 2019 - 2020<br/>– Advisor : Prof. Lek-Heng Lim</li><li>● <b>Sun Yat-sen University (SYSU)</b> Guangzhou, China<br/><i>B.S. in Information and Computing Science</i> 2015 - 2019</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |  |  |
| RESEARCH INTEREST | <b>Methodology</b> : Stochastic Programming, Nonconvex Optimization.<br><b>Application</b> : Operations Models, Optimal Control, Reinforcement Learning.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |  |
| PREPRINTS         | <ol style="list-style-type: none"><li>1. <b>Hidden Convexity in Queueing Models.</b> <a href="#">[ArXiv]</a> <a href="#">[SSRN]</a><br/>Xin Chen, Linwei Xin, <b>Minda Zhao</b> (alphabetical order)<br/>– Under major revision at <i>Operations Research</i>.</li><li>2. <b>A Simple Solution to Improving Human Supervision of Algorithms : Evidence from Smart Vending.</b> <a href="#">[SSRN]</a><br/><b>Minda Zhao</b>, Brian Han, Xin Chen, Tao Zhu<br/>– Under major revision at <i>Manufacturing &amp; Service Operations Management</i>.<br/>– <b>Winner</b>, POMS College of BOM Junior Scholar Paper Competition, 2026.<br/>– Selected as an oral presentation at MSOM Supply Chain SIG 2025.<br/>– <b>Third Place</b>, CSAMSE Practice Award 2024.</li><li>3. <b>Landscape of Policy Optimization for Finite Horizon MDPs with General State and Action.</b> <a href="#">[ArXiv]</a><br/>Xin Chen, Yifan Hu, <b>Minda Zhao</b> (alphabetical order)<br/>– Under revision at <i>Operations Research</i>.</li></ol> |  |  |
| PUBLICATIONS      | <ol style="list-style-type: none"><li>1. <b>Stochastic Steffensen Method.</b> <a href="#">[Link]</a><br/><b>Minda Zhao</b>, Zehua Lai, Lek-Heng Lim. 2024<br/><i>Computational Optimization and Applications</i>, pp.1-32.</li></ol>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |  |  |
| HONORS AND AWARDS | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● <b>Winner</b>, POMS College of BOM Junior Scholar Paper Competition 2026</li><li>● Shabbir Ahmed PhD Fellowship for Excellence in Research 2025<br/>– Awarded annually to up to two Ph.D. students in Georgia Tech ISyE for research in optimization</li><li>● <b>Third Place</b>, CSAMSE Practice Award 2024</li><li>● NCCR Automation Fellowship, Switzerland 2024</li><li>● Hansen Fellowship, UIUC 2021</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |  |
| TEACHING          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● <b>Instructor</b><br/>– Supply Chain Modeling : Logistics (Georgia Tech, undergraduate course) Summer 2026</li><li>● <b>Teaching Assistant</b><br/>– Convexity (by Prof. Arkadi Nemirovski at Georgia Tech, graduate course) Spring 2026</li><li>● <b>Guest Lecturer</b><br/>– Optimization and Learning in Operations (by Prof. Xin Chen at Georgia Tech, graduate course) Spring 2025</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |  |

CONFERENCE  
PRESENTATIONS

- **Hidden Convexity in Queueing Models.**
  - INFORMS IOS Conference, Atlanta, GA Mar 2026
  - (Poster) Cornell Young Researchers Workshop, Ithaca, NY Oct 2025
- **A Simple Solution to Improving Human Supervision of Algorithms : Evidence from Smart Vending.**
  - INFORMS MSOM Conference, Supply Chain Management SIG, London, UK Jun 2025
  - Annual POMS Conference, Atlanta, GA May 2025
  - Conference on Digital Experimentation @ MIT, Boston, MA Oct 2024
- **Landscape of Policy Optimization for Finite Horizon MDPs with General State and Action.**
  - INFORMS IOS Conference, Atlanta, GA Mar 2026
  - (Poster) NeurIPS 2025 ML×OR Workshop, San Diego, CA Dec 2025
  - INFORMS Annual Meeting, Atlanta, GA Oct 2025
  - International Conference on Continuous Optimization, Los Angeles, CA Jul 2025
  - INFORMS RMP Section Conference, New York, NY Jul 2025
  - INFORMS APS Conference, Atlanta, GA Jun 2025
  - IISE Annual Conference & Expo, Atlanta, GA Jun 2025
  - Annual POMS Conference, Atlanta, GA May 2025
  - INFORMS Annual Meeting, Seattle, WA Oct 2024
  - (Poster) Cornell Young Researchers Workshop, Ithaca, NY Oct 2024
  - Purdue Operations Conference, West Lafayette, IN Aug 2024
  - INFORMS Annual Meeting, Phoenix, AZ Oct 2023
  - International Annual Conference of CSAMSE, Shenzhen, China Jul 2023

SERVICES

- **Session Organization :**
  - INFORMS Annual Meeting Nov 2026  
Session : Inventory Management in Logistics Systems : Policies, Learning, and Asymptotic Insights
  - International Conference on Continuous Optimization (ICCOPT 2025) Jul 2025  
Session : Recent Advances in Optimization for MDPs and Stochastic Optimal Control
- **Reviewer :**
  - *Operations Research*
  - *Management Science*
  - *Manufacturing & Service Operations Management*
  - *Computational Optimization and Applications*

INDUSTRY  
EXPERIENCE

- **Shenzhen Fengyi Technology Co., Ltd.** Shenzhen, China
  - Research Assistant (remote)* Mar 2022 - Present
  - Research Scientist Intern* Jul 2023 - Aug 2023
  - Developed and implemented a new replenishment strategy, reducing annual inventory costs by \$1,000,000.
- **Cainiao Network** Hangzhou, China
  - Research Scientist Intern* Jun 2021 – Oct 2021

REFERENCES

- **Xin Chen (Professor)**
  - H. Milton Stewart School of Industrial and Systems Engineering, Georgia Tech
  - Email : xin.chen@isye.gatech.edu
- **Linwei Xin (Associate Professor)**
  - School of Operations Research and Information Engineering, Cornell University
  - Email : lx267@cornell.edu
- **Guanghui (George) Lan (Professor)**
  - H. Milton Stewart School of Industrial and Systems Engineering, Georgia Tech
  - Email : george.lan@isye.gatech.edu